

Fragments of a Dream

31st December, 1978 2.00am.

I dreamt that I was swimming beside a beach with a French and an English priests. The French priest proclaimed that French was ineffective in preaching for French was not English. Waves carried me away to shore - somehow when I walked through the forest, I met Ivan Wong. I walked along a path which was gradually obstructed by a chestbox. I went into a restaurant and saw many friends. I sat with Ng Hung Cheung, Young Chi Hung and possibly Mak Tak Ming. The restaurant was like a theatre. I saw my father and wanted to note him but I did not. I returned home and slept and became a psychotic in the midst of the night. My house was covered up with curtains and was dark and dull. I wanted to go to the lavatory but it was occupied. I was extremely painful mentally. I woke up.

Fragments of two dreams 8th January, 1979 1.00a.m.

I participated in a poetry writing competition but the selection committee openly announced that I did not pass. Somehow, I dreamt that besides joining this competition, I answered questions in an English Examination. I answered the last question but was not marked.

for I had answered an extra one. I could remember that my result was not good. I had a dream within the dream: - I saw a baby & a girl looking into a sac. A naked man suddenly appeared and approached them gradually as the girl looked into the sac.

I went back from swimming and came to a place like HKU with Peter Li. I was waiting outside the place (like the entrance to the HKBC). I went to a lavatory nearby and found that Lee Kar Shun and three other Josephians practising ~~homon~~ games. I tried to study them by pretending to write; but could not. They laughed at me and told me to leave. I returned and found Lam Ching Fung there. Numerous people came out from the building. Lam said that he saw an acquainted Father and wanted to hide away. I went to another lavatory again; it was a large one with an ascending stairway; adjoining the building from the other side was another staircase. I started to climb it and found that a beautiful car (with bar) was exhibited in the hall next to it. I went up the stairway which led to a restaurant in which slices of meat were hung from some hedges. There was boiling meat in a place (like the panorama in the HKBC) for buffet. I woke up.

A dream 9th January, 1979 5.30 a.m.

I intended to catch a train leaving at 4.28 p.m. The railway station had four ascending platforms. I went to the second one in

which I was led to a restaurant by a long corridor. It was an old restaurant run by foreigners. A South American waiter told me to sit down. I ordered an apple pie and a cup of tea. He asked me whether I liked 'Briston' with confusion (Britain or Briton?). Then I met Lon Hon Fai and Ho Jan Ping. The feminine girl I liked sat in the next table with two boys and several girls. Yet, the two boys were not good-looking. One of them held her hand but she started to withdraw. The train suddenly took the scene of a ferry and it sailed to a strange countryside (I had a feeling that it was Ma Wan or so-). I saw many seagulls and started to take pictures of them. The ferry sailed near the place, which was like a park. I dashed about to find the feminine girl and was so uneasy that my classmates started to question me.

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20th March, 1979

These two months are but my crazy months - I am the forerunner of ~~travelling~~; I play, I play the game of hockey. Majoring in 'Physics', I attend only one to two lessons of Physics each week. I just feel that I start to withdraw from interpersonal relations in the Baptist College. Even, I am an outsider to the Baptist students. The so-called Christian atmosphere stifles me. H. The feminine girl I am infatuated with grows prouder and prouder. I can sense her snobbish air. Indeed, she deserves - she is extremely charming and enticing. It can be said that I am quite prestigious in the college; but I do not want it; at least, I keep to myself. My acquaintances and friends in the college do not know my past.

I also come to feel that my intellectual powers gradually deteriorate, not because of aging or illness; but because of ontological insecurity. My power of expression diminishes and disorganization reaches a surface level which even finds its revelation in speech and use of language.

Can I stand? My life is so dissolute, so sluggish
and pallid. I notice that I am behaving in a schizophrenic
way. I feel that I am very withdrawn - I even feel anxious
when I am in the Baptist College. I have no strength to go on.
My relationship with the Christians remains intact. I went to
see Mrs. Hackett last Friday about the paper. For some time,
she was very firm in her belief (and for all time as well).
I had been very sarcastic and contemptuous in my last
paper - I knew that this would not do, but I cannot help
I need support and find none. I want a feminine god.
I would not turn to 'God' for I know what the Christians
are doing. Mrs. Hackett, I think, deceives herself so well
that she is just caught in that vicious circle of faith.
May, 1979

Sometimes, I just want to get to my feelings.
15th May, 1979

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Perhaps I do not know what I am doing: - I live just like a living organism under stress. My feelings are all dead - all congealed up in a boomerang. They are all too remote, too indifferent to my life; and they hang up like ghosts. They seep through my ego-shell, drop by drop. It seems to me that I am not living in the present, nor in the past or future; but that I come from a no-man land, a land where spectres are even frightened to death. I have lost spontaneity in writing and speaking. I am so preoccupied with myself. When I take up my ball-pen, I have no desire to write and this happens now. I leave myself and get lost and dissipated in the world. Maybe. I want a girl to collect my distraught pieces back and glue them with her love. And I shall be real and expanding again.

17th May, 1979

Am I having too much? Not at all! Hope or no hope: I grow too old to do again, or just a bit more. I see too little, but I feel too much and have no feeling at all. Without power to change my life? My own life? Why? What for? I am old enough to be young. I wish I could have a thousand faces. May I be a paranoid or schizophrenic

and a psychiatrist combined; or a mad scientist and a wet aspid
19th May, 1979.

I saw my dear Christians yesterday - they were quite withdrawn
and unable to assert themselves, instead of their usual ^{vivacity} ~~vivacity~~
and aggressiveness. I just do not know - they are just too
narrow-minded. Actually, I was quite surprised of Elite -
he tried to comment on my essay published in the
Hadesgrad, and seemed to be puzzled by my incongruence
(pessimism and optimism) in my writing. I just think that
it is a question of style, rather than a question of
my theme. When we spoke about religion, the Christians
always attempted to defend their position by denial - they
are just greenhorns.

21st May, 1979.

I received a phone from Mr. Cheng Tsang Shing. I
just can't imagine how pestering he could be. He
raised numerous questions - most of them were just trivial.
He is a 'Physics' major and attends every lesson. He clings
to people like parasites, questioning and pestering and does

so only for himself! I just can't imagine how terrible he is. It is said that he has quite excellent musical ability - he can play Chinese harp very well. The world is just absurd - I cannot see his life open on anything substantial. He is not just infantile. I cannot see his worth.

28/5/79.

I feel that love is usually followed by a heightened level of sensitivity. Any displeasure of the lover may be taken as a sign of rejection. It is usually the intermediate phase of love. Insecurity in any form of infantile behaviour will come to the surface when a person is in love. I doubt that if it is avoidable.

30/5/79. 9.30pm

Records of 3 dreams

31/5/79

I was having a game when other passengers on a No. 170 bus. The game consisted of combining different ^{wooden} pieces of 'words' to form a poem. We competed with each alternate row of passengers. After that, I dismantled the bus.

near Euston. I wanted to make a shortcut to my house
and went into a large building. I found that it was
a Yee Chun. Feeling terrified, I left the place. I
woke up 1.40 a.m. 31/5/79

I wanted to escape from an impending flood
and had to escape by driving a car with my wife
(the feminine girl) and my daughter. Our car rusted and
had to be pulled or pushed up a concave slope.
Two other men helped me. I woke up 2.10 a.m.

I was told to investigate cases of poisoning and
I found a cave temple through a sloping path.
I saw four monks go through the cave below and
met Francis and Bernard. I asked which living organisms
could emit cyanide. I was then bitten by a rugged-
scale snake and was rushed to the hospital near
Tobago restaurant. I could remember that we had to chase
an ambulance. A group of St. John Ambulance Gacks
performed first aid upon me but were very
unskilled. I was then saved by injection of serum.
A male nurse tried to conduct systematic desensitization
by rubbing a rugged-scale snake against my arm.
5.00 a.m.

Christianity is characterized by its delusional system. Paranoid behaviors can be seen among the Christians to reinforce their system. Somewhat, somehow, I cannot see any wisdom in the dogmas themselves. The Christians usually invent arguments or 'proofs' to justify their faith, though they claim that faith in Christ requires no justification. Yet is, I believe, a way to escape their problems through rationalization. Or, when they cannot defend, they resolve to deny the existence of such problems.

1/6/79

My years in the Baptist - An autobiographical note into absurdity (1)

Nowhere? No man? No land! And so is the Baptist College; renowned as the gateway to Hell as Heaven, or Heaven as Hell. Surely, it stands; it stands with the infamous title, 'One of the most absurd post-secondary institutions in Hong Kong.' Each student is required to attend a 'course' termed Assembly, in which the gospel is preached and prayer is conducted. If the student is absent for ^{more than} two periods, he will be graded as unsatisfactory (failure). Each student is required to take a course in

'the Philosophy of College Life' and a course in the Bible through which Christian dogmas are instilled. However, each student is required to obey the commands of the school authority. Even our celebrated President, Dr. Daniel Lee, took the pleasure in maintaining this truth, and justified himself by presenting arguments of 'freedom does not precede obedience' or such and such.

6/6/79

I was told to complete an application form of CI for my mother. I got annoyed when she mistook my filling some items I filled in. Then I began to ask her questions angrily on the various items and she began to answer angrily. Finally, she bursted in rage and started to call me names. She cried to say that she had endured much; she had been altruistic and I did not regard her as my mother. She then cried and said that she could leave the house and make her living outside. After that, if she could not work, she would commit suicide or that she would strangle me before she killed herself. She stressed that she could leave or kill herself for she had no hope, nor any

zeal in life at all. Motor activity increased and she
tried to hide herself in the lavatory. She claimed
that I would take pleasure in seeing her die.
She cried out loud that I was inhumane, wicked, perverse
and bestial. She said that I looked down upon her
because of my knowledge. My father even invoked 'authority'
(such as the Bible) to show that I should be respectful
to the parents.

Analysis

1. My mother is highly dependent on me, leading to the unrealistic conception of my power. In short, she has projected the qualities of an ideal husband on me.
2. Threat of suicide and homicide, stress on my ~~to~~ difficult birth served to provoke guilt feeling and my attention.
3. The attempt to dominate was frustrated. Possessiveness & power relations appear onto the surface.

6/6/79

I think that I am correct to say that the 'love' of Rebecca Khan for me was only a projection derived from her past experience, a pattern of transference phenomenon and an attachment post hoc combined. It was but a fantasy. Although I cannot like her or even accept her, I am pleased to see that she has resolved this crisis through a more realistic grasp of it. Her letter to Julia showed at least that she can realize she was in ^(passively accept) 'love' with my image, not my person. On the whole, I know but cannot appreciate her deliberate but artificial attempt to please, her caricature of her expressions, (especially facial) and her authoritarian nature (or we can say 'submissive' or 'complying'). Most of all, I am quite disgusted of her excessive efforts and tendency to please authoritarian figures. Perhaps I am a bit fastidious, but I simply do not like her, even as a friend. Of course, it is my subjective feeling and may spring from my own psychological make-up, which determines my prejudice against her. My first impression of her may be quite good but it deteriorates almost exponentially after I know her. I can only say that she cannot share my life (nor can I share her life with her) with me. She is not in that position. She's not in that stage.

The basic social relation in her world is based upon authoritarian power, which is clearly related to her upbringing in a patriarchal family. Power is not distributed but centralized. Human relations are reduced to power struggles, in which only victory or subjugation exist. This can be reflected in her dealings with authoritarian figures, or even seniors - she deliberately pleases them in order to obtain 'reward'. Her basic defense mechanisms are projection and denial. Under the stress of cleavage from the group, she (I think) demonstrated mild paranoid symptoms. She claimed that Maria was my reflection and that Julia resembled me. Aggressiveness and masculinity were other characteristics of her core personality.

I do not intend to have any deep self-disclosure before her, partly because of my own insecurity and disgust. Besides, I do not want to 'wake' her up from her present life - I have no right to do so (rationalization it may be!).

I am very rational and cool, and I do not know whether I love Maria or not. She is not beautiful, but she has some very charming qualities. Julia has asked me and told me that Maria possesses many internal values. She is only a bit lazy.

and not beautiful and that's all. On my part, I can sense that sometimes I have that feeling of love towards her, sometimes not. I can remember that on one occasion (I think it was Chinese New Year Eve), I had a strong inclination to hold her hand when we were in the bus-stop. These happen quite frequently.

Perhaps we both feel it would be quite inappropriate. We always interact in a rational way. Maria somewhat seems to show love through trivial actions, though I do not know whether she 'is or not'. Sometimes, when I produce emotion-laden conflicts or experiences and want to share with her (in an explorative manner), she will immediately withdraw and remark that I am too mature to and so and that I can handle my problems. Perhaps she knows that I was devoted to the feminine girl and would only share my being with her (I told Maria several times about my problem of sharing). Julia commented that I did not pass the preliminary stage of love - I still hold that beauty is everything and will love only beautiful girls. What if I meet an understanding belle after I fall in love with Maria? What will I do? Will I desert her? I do not want to desert Maria. If I love her, I want to love her to the mat and to our death. I want to

share my deepest being with her. I just feel that our relationship lacks something. We already have warmth, mutual respect and understanding. I think she accepts me and I accept her. Yet, I think both of us do ^{not} have any feeling of reincarnation, exaltation or consummation.

Maria is very clever in interpersonal relations. Somewhat, I do not know what games she plays. If she is willing to induce my emotional catharsis and love me, I ~~probably~~ probably will exalt her to my goddesses.

I do not know whether I have passed the stage of wanting belles or not. If I have, I think Maria is the most beautiful woman (I mean girl) in the world.

20/6/79.

Somewhat, Maria is like a cup of best wine - the more I drink, the more intense my feelings are. We both know our positions well and I think we both grasp our situations. I want to tell Maria what I feel towards her. I know that she has changed me without any intention to change me on her part. I feel that it is extremely precious. Her world is filled with, I don't know, perhaps

wonders Maria, I think I shall be very frank with you.
Somehow, you show me the way to live and to love -
beauty and truth dwell in our concrete life as well as in
our abstract mind.

29/6/79

I feel afraid of something. I should be more emotional;
but I am not. I am quite apprehensive of Maria's left
knee. She complained that it was painful for weeks.
Still, she has pain and has to go for a x-ray
check-up tomorrow. Too much happened and they happen
too fast. I just feel that I am carried away by
time, without any feeling at all. Somewhat, I am
ambivalent towards Maria. I feel that I have simultaneous
wishes for her to be dead and alive. Some questions
just emerge - what will I do if she gets cancer?
What will she do if she gets cancer? Or that what
will I do if I get cancer? What will she do then?
Or if one of us has an accident? All crazy thoughts
I know. Is it true that I have certain hidden
hostility towards Maria? I have isolated many things.
What will I do if she becomes handicapped; or vice versa?

Will I still love her? Will she love me then?
Will I abandon her? Will she abandon me? Maybe
our feeling of love for each other is not strong. There
is something blocking both of us. We need to be
madly in love.

I think I am quite concerned with her knee
but I feel that I get no feeling - or I get even
negative feeling. I do not know. Help me to love
Maria.

17/7/79

I am but the King of Salad Dress. Perhaps too
much has happened during the past few days. Maria and I
fall in love. Rebecca, before we admitted the affair, tried
to invoke 'authority' (mother of Maria) to control the situation.
These happened twice.....

21/7/79

Perhaps Josephine Maria Tam Mee Chun has entered my life. Somewhat I know or I do not know. Her face appears in my consciousness. I grow accustomed to her face. The ways she smiles, the ways she bites her lips (rips her lower lip) and the ways she makes faces really drive me crazy. She is extremely beautiful in her ways!

1/8/79